Threat Intelligence Report

Lazarus Group

Date: 25APRIL2026

Report Type: Portfolio

Focus: Advanced Persistent Threat (APT) Analysis

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Discipline: Threat Intelligence

Version: 1.0

Executive Summary

This report provides an analytical overview of the threat actor known as the Lazarus Group, based on Open-Source Intelligence (OSINT), dark web intelligence sources, and publicly available reporting. The assessment examines observed behavior, including actor background, targeting patterns and victimology, tactics, techniques and procedures (TTPs), indicators of compromise (IOCs), and an overall evaluation of capability and intent. The objective of this report is to consolidate available intelligence into a structured threat profile that supports understanding of associated risk, operational behavior, and observed activity attributed to the actor.

Methodology

This report was developed using Open-Source Intelligence (OSINT) and dark web–derived information obtained from publicly accessible and reputable sources, including security research publications, news reporting, technical analyses, and indexed web content. Structured queries were used to identify relevant information relating to Lazarus Group infrastructure, behavioral patterns, and associated identifiers.
All information was evaluated for credibility, relevance, and corroboration across multiple sources prior to inclusion. No unauthorized access, private datasets, or proprietary systems were used. The research was conducted using lawful and ethical methods for analytical and educational purposes.

Report Sections

- **Section 1: Threat Actor Overview**
- **Section 2: Targeting & Victimology**
- **Section 3: Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures (TTPs)**
- **Section 4: Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)**
- **Section 5: Analytic Assessment**

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Findings of Interest

Section 1: Threat Actor Overview

- Lazarus Group is a North Korea linked advanced persistent threat (APT) actor assessed to operate as part of the Democratic People's Republic of Korea (DPRK) state cyber operations ecosystem. The group conducts both espionage and financially motivated cyber operations, often through distinct but overlapping sub-clusters, including APT38. **(Figure 1)**

- Active since at least the mid-2000s, Lazarus is widely recognized as one of the most established APT groups globally. Its activity has been consistently attributed by multiple government and private-sector intelligence organizations, reflecting a sustained, state-directed capability. Reporting also indicates DPRK prioritizes technical talent from STEM fields to support its cyber operations infrastructure. **(Figure 2)**

Lazarus Group – Names by Organization

- **U.S. Government:** HIDDEN COBRA
- **MITRE ATT&CK:** Lazarus Group (G0032)
- **Microsoft Threat Intelligence:** ZINC, Diamond Sleet
- **CrowdStrike:** Labyrinth Chollima, Stardust Chollima
- **Mandiant (Google):** APT38 (financial subgroup) **(Figure 3)**
- **Secureworks:** NICKEL ACADEMY
- **Broadcom:** Lazarus Group
- **Historical Names:** Guardians of Peace, BeagleBoyz, Bluenoroff, Andariel.

Lazarus Group

Lazarus Group is a North Korean state-sponsored cyber threat group attributed to the Reconnaissance General Bureau (RGB). [1] [2] Lazarus Group has been active since at least 2009 and is reportedly responsible for the November 2014 destructive wiper attack on Sony Pictures Entertainment, identified by Novetta as part of Operation Blockbuster.

Figure 1

That means the North Korean regime hand-picks and trains its hacking elite.

Figure 2

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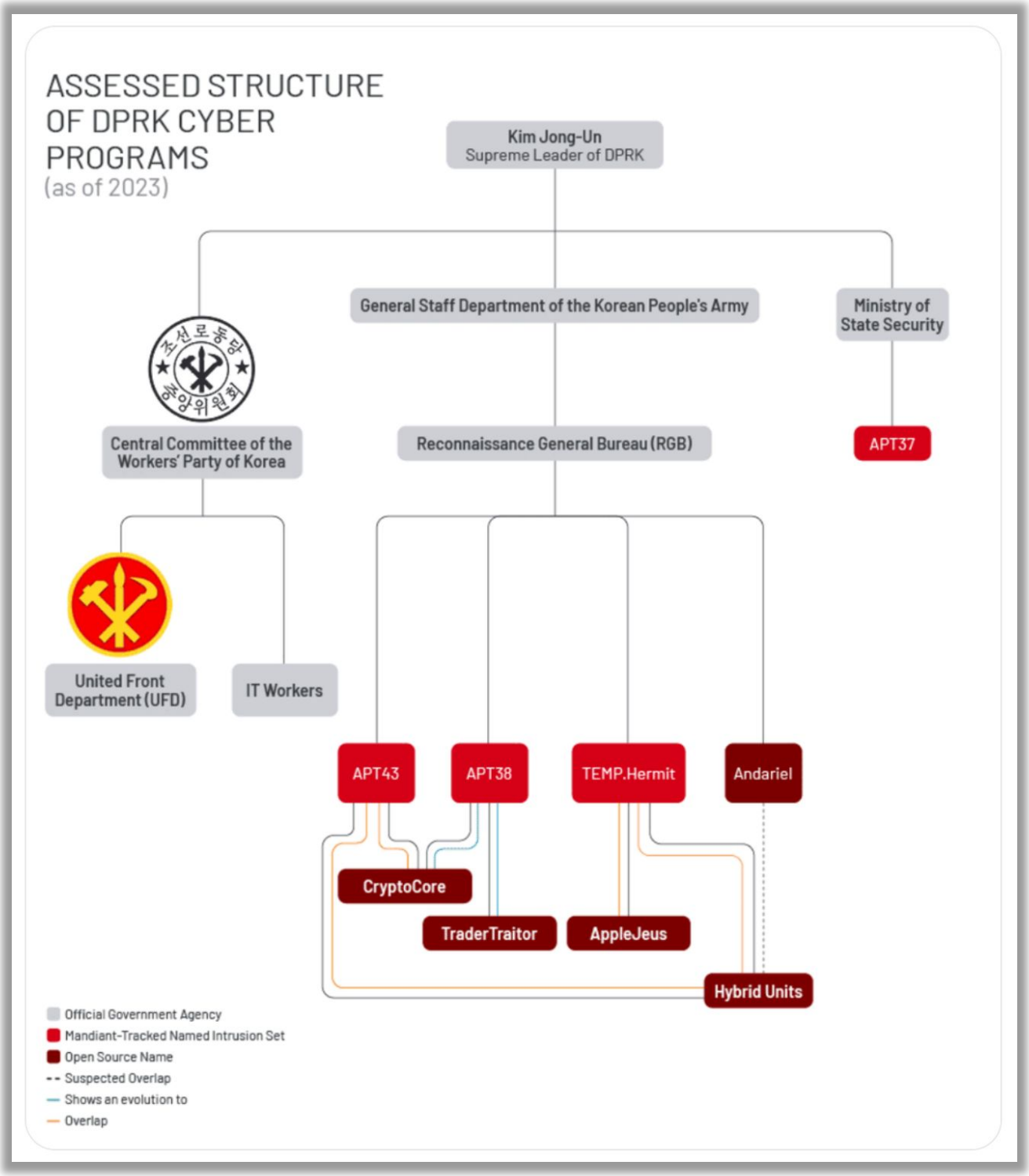

Figure 3

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Section 2: Targeting & Victimology

- Lazarus Group selects targets based on financial value and strategic intelligence gain, focusing on organizations who yield either monetary profit or sensitive information. **(Figures 4 - 5)**

Primary Targets:

- Cryptocurrency exchanges & wallets
- Global banking infrastructure (SWIFT-related systems)
- Defense contractors & aerospace organizations
- Government agencies
- Media / entertainment sector

Victimology Pattern:

- High-value financial systems
- Organizations with sensitive intelligence value
- Crypto platforms with weak operational security

SUSPECTED VICTIMS

South Korea, Sony Pictures Entertainment , United States, Bangladesh Bank, Defense companies in Israel and the Middle East, Global banks, U.S. defense contractors

Figure 4

North Korea continues to aggressively target the cryptocurrency industry to raise funds for its nuclear and ballistic missile programs, bypassing international sanctions.

Since 2016, the amount of cryptocurrency stolen by North Korea-linked groups reached an estimated six-point-75 billion dollars as of the end 2025, according to the blockchain analysis company Chainalysis.

Figure 5

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Section 3: Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures (TTPs)

- Lazarus Group uses various phishing, malware, and stealth techniques to break into systems, stay hidden, and steal data.

  Initial Access (getting in): Spearphishing (T1566), Malicious Attachments **(Figure 6)**
  - They trick users into opening fake emails or files to gain access.

  Execution (running commands): PowerShell (T1059.001), Command Shell (T1059.003)
  - They run malicious commands using Windows tools.

  Persistence (staying inside): Registry Run Keys (T1547), Scheduled Tasks (T1053)
  - They make malware start automatically on reboot.

  Credential Access (stealing logins): Credential Dumping (T1003)
  - They steal usernames and passwords from infected systems.

  Defense Evasion (hiding activity): Obfuscated Files (T1027), Timestomping (T1070.006)
  - They hide malware and make files look normal.

  Lateral Movement (moving across systems): SMB (T1021.002), RDP (T1021.001)
  - They spread to other computers in the network.

  Command & Control (remote control): HTTPS (T1071), Encrypted channels
  - They control infected systems over hidden connections.

  Exfiltration (stealing data): Over C2 channel (T1041), Cloud services
  - They send stolen data back to themselves.

- **Analyst Comments:** Lazarus Group uses legitimate Windows tools such as Remote Desktop Protocol (RDP) and Server Message Block (SMB) to move within compromised networks while blending in with normal admin activity. This approach is typically used after initial access has been gained to reduce detection and maintain persistence. In contrast, initial compromise is often achieved through malicious software or social engineering techniques designed to gain entry and deploy malware. **(Figure 7)**

Enterprise	T1566	.001	Phishing: Spearphishing Attachment	Lazarus Group has targeted victims with spearphishing emails containing malicious Microsoft Word documents.[33][20][24][25]

Figure 6

The malware is often delivered via indirect dependencies, making detection challenging. The campaign demonstrates patience and operational security, with attackers publishing benign packages to gain downloads and trust before switching to malicious versions. The

Figure 7

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Section 4: Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

- The “TraderTraitor” campaign is associated with North Korean state-sponsored cyber activity linked to the Lazarus Group ecosystem. The following indicators were identified from trojanized cryptocurrency applications and supporting infrastructure.

Malicious Domains
- tokenais[.]com **(Figure 8)**
- cryptais[.]com

- Used to host fake cryptocurrency/AI trading applications and deliver malware through deceptive downloads and installers.

Command-and-Control (C2) Infrastructure
- hxxps://www.esilet[.]com/update/
- hxxps://sche-eg[.]org/plugins/top.php **(Figure 9)**
- hxxps://dafnefonseca[.]com/wp-content/themes/top.php

- Used for remote communication and payload delivery to infected hosts, enabling attacker control and staged malware execution.

File Hashes (Malware Samples)
- 60b3cfe2ec3100caf4afde734cfd5147f78acf58ab17d4480196831db4aa5f18 **(Figure 10)**
- f0e8c29e3349d030a97f4a8673387c2e21858cccd1fb9ebbf9009b27743b2e5b
- 5b40b73934c1583144f41d8463e227529fa7157e26e6012babd062e3fd7e0b03

- Associated with trojanized cryptocurrency/AI trading applications delivering remote access capability.

Malware
- Manuscrypt (RAT)

- Remote system control, data theft, and secondary payload deployment across compromised machines.

- **Analyst Comments:** This reporting reflects indicators associated with a single identified campaign within the broader Lazarus Group ecosystem. This is not an exhaustive list of the actor’s broader infrastructure or activity scope.

tokenais[.]com

Information as of January 2022:

IP Address: 199.188.103[.]115

Registrar: NameCheap, Inc.

Created: January 27, 2022

Expires: January 27, 2023

Figure 8

C2 Endpoints:

- hxxps://sche-eg[.]org/plugins/top.php

Figure 9

SHA-1: b2d9ca7b6d1bbbe4864ea11dfca343b7e15597d8

SHA-256:

60b3cfe2ec3100caf4afde734cfd5147f78acf58ab17d4480196831db4aa5f18

Figure 10

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Section 5: Analytic Assessment

- Lazarus Group is assessed as a highly capable, state-linked threat actor operating on behalf of North Korea, conducting a broad range of cyber operations that include both financially motivated activity and strategic espionage. **(Figures 11 - 13)**
- **Threat Level: High** - Based on demonstrated operational sophistication, sustained campaign activity, and the actor's ability to rapidly adapt tooling and infrastructure. Lazarus Group continues to present a significant risk due to its combination of financial theft objectives and intelligence-gathering operations aligned with state priorities.

"What makes Lazarus especially dangerous right now is their activity level," Newson said. "KelpDAO, Drift, and now a new macOS malware kit, all within the same month. This isn't random hacking; it's a state-directed financial operation running at a scale and speed typical of institutions."

Figure 11

Lazarus Group has become especially dangerous with new Mach-O Man attack: CertiK

North Korea's Lazarus Group has a new attack vector that allows it to exploit an apparently routine business call as a gateway into a target's systems.

Figure 12

The Lazarus Group is a highly sophisticated, state-sponsored cyber threat group attributed to the North Korean government. They are also known by many other names, including Hidden Cobra, APT38, and Guardians of Peace. Active since at least 2009, this group is one of the most prolific and dangerous advanced persistent threat (APT) actors in the world. Their attacks are not only for cyber espionage but also for financially motivated cybercrime, which sets them apart from most other state-backed actors.

Figure 13

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